**Observatorium is a studio for public art and place-making** in cities and landscapes, founded 1997 in Rotterdam, Netherlands. The founders and partner are visual artists Geert van de Camp, Andre Dekker, Lieven Poutsma, Ruud Reutelingsperger, living and working in Rotterdam with backgrounds in architecture, art, education and writing. Their works of art are commissioned by public bodies, instutions of visual art and citizens. Observatorium developes an artform that generates as much attention for the world around us as for itself. At best, it creates a sense of wonder in often already magical places.

**Public Art**
The artists work on representations of local culture in urban public space and the natural environment in many countries and produce strategic planning, placemaking, public works of art and related public events. Their award winning public artworks vary from large scale sculptures to gardens and pavilions, all providing opportunities for gathering, dialogue, comtemplation or special events. Observatorium has published several books on public art, partcipated in important exhibitions and received stipends and grants from major Dutch funds of architecture, design and art and won international awards in the fields of art, architecture and public space.

**Attitude**
If public art is to accomplish anything in the interaction between the work of art, the site and the viewer or user, it is simply: time and space for attention and curiosity for what lies outside us, for where we are now and how our attention resonates within us. Ideally, Observatorium creates works of art that generate as much attention for the world around us as it receives for itself: a place, a sculpture or architecture to look at, and to look away from. If the visitor's back is turned to the work of art, peering into the world or the community, it is good.

**Sites**
In the grey areas and overlaps of urban design, landscape architecture, architecture and art, their works of art help creating new meaning and uses to sites and environments that are in transit. Urban parks, prisons, spoil tips, housing estates, motorways, nature reserves and industrial heritage are all part of Observatorium's field of operations in cities and around the world. The artists use the media of sculpture, architecture and art installation to make functional facilities for sites, landscapes and communities in transition.

**Public function**
The objects itself are monumental, symbolic and meaningful. The public artwork, meant for multiple uses connected to the context, attracts people because of it’s inviting and generous character. As part of their usually large scale projects Observatorium uses placemaking tools as a way of engaging the community, raising awareness of the culture and future of sites. The oeuvre is characterized by the paradoxes of poetic/robust and iconic/hospitable and is always embedded in urban or landscape developments. The work ranges from scenography to park design and from modular architecture to event buildings.

**Publications**
As a way of sharing their knowledge with spatial disciplines, commissioners and the wider art audience Observatorium has published on public art philosophies, methods and own projects: Big Pieces of Time, 2010; The Green Shadow, 2016; Zollverein Park, 2016; Hidden Landscape, 2017 and De Dwarsligger van Aalst, 2017. In 2022 they summarized their intentions and insights in Public Art for Public Life, nai010 Publishers.

**Statement**
“We are always trying to evoke a contemplative moment in which the audience is connected with the actual physical site and a deep sense of the condition humaine. At best a work of art creates a sense of wonder in often already magical places.“

**Selection of projects**
2023 Shelter for walkers along the Way of St James, La Romieu, Gers (F)
2022 Earthwork in the Wadden Sea Unesco World Heritage salt marshes, Village Blije, Friesland
2022 Place du Torrent with landscape architect Arpentère, Université Grenoble
2021 Exhibition Land of Chabot, Chabot Museum Rotterdam (NL)
2021 Pavilion Stadtkrone, City of Dorsten
2020 Sculpture Wandelgang in collaboration with poet Barbara Köhler for public art show by curator Florian Matzner, Kunstsammlungen Chemnitz (DE)
2019 Scenography The Reason I Jump in a public park with theatre director Graham Eatough, Glasgow (UK)
2019 park pavilion Zandpoort, City of Tilburg
2018 Straatkijkers, a family of 9 viewing platforms along a city boulevard, Rotterdam (NL)
2017 Dwarsligger, pontoon bridge for performances and communal use in urban development process, Aalst (B)
2015 Landmark and concept for building with nature Zandwacht, Port of Rotterdam (NL)
2016 Floating architecture and performance Nomanslanding, Sydney (AUS)/ Duisburg (D)/ Glasgow (UK)
2014 Concept and realization world heritage site Zollverein Park with landscape architects Planergruppe Oberhausen, including entrance pavilions, Essen (DE)
2012 Sculpture Péage Sauvage for triennale Estuaire, curator David Moinard, Nantes (FR)
2012 City highway junction transformation KleinpolderpleinPark, Rotterdam (NL)
2010 - 2017 Mobile architecture Waiting for the River for Emscherkunst triennale (D)
2008 Pausa, temporary museum room for architecture biennale, Venice (IT)
2008 Steel frame Dutchbarn and park concept for spoil tip park with landscape architects WES, Hamburg, Neukirchen-Vluyn (DE)
2001 Highway garden, monument and pavilion for Nieuw-Terbregge, Rotterdam (NL)
2000 Hoftorenkantoortuin, Courtyard with open plan office, Ministery of Culture, Den Haag (NL)
1999 Netherland, NY, concept for island in Hudson Bay, F. Taylor Gallery, New York (US)
1997 Dwelling for Seclusion, Art in General and Snug Harbor, New York (US)

**Maatschap (partnership) Observatorium**
**Studio address: Robert Fruinstraat 53, NL-3021 XE Rotterdam – The Netherlands**
**www.observatorium.org/**
**Social media: #ObservatoriumRotterdam**

Partners
Geert van de Camp; Oss, 1962/ Enschede AKI, Art Academy
Andre Dekker; Delft, 1956/ Rotterdam, Pedagogische Academie
Lieven Poutsma; Hardenberg, 1987/ Den Haag, Royal Art Academy
Ruud Reutelingsperger; Sittard, 1963/ Den Bosch, Royal Art Academy